

Stakeholder Grievance Procedure

How any stakeholder can raise a concern, and how we respond — fairly, promptly, and without retaliation.

Issued by	Praxis Brands Ltd, trading as Stennah & Hope Bespoke Fragrances and Candles
Company number	17222158 (England and Wales)
Applies to	All stakeholders of Praxis Brands Ltd, across manufacturing and investment activity
Owner	Grievance Officer (Section 6)
Approved by	Boyowa Olugbo, Managing Director
Version / effective date	2.2 — effective 15 August 2026
Next review	15 August 2027 — annually, or sooner on change in law or operations
Published at	praxisbrands.co.uk/grievance — freely accessible, no login required

1. Purpose

Praxis Brands Ltd is committed to operating fairly and responsibly towards everyone affected by our business. This procedure sets out how any stakeholder can raise a grievance, and how we will handle it consistently, confidentially and without unreasonable delay.

It gives practical effect to the stakeholder duties set out in our Foundational Thesis. A concern about how a product was made, how a supplier was paid, how a colleague was treated, or how a founder was dealt with reaches the same company and the same Board.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to grievances raised by any of our stakeholders, including:

- employees, workers, apprentices, contractors, freelancers and job applicants;
- suppliers and their workers, including those further down our supply chain;
- clients, brand partners, founders we have invested in, and business partners;
- customers and end users of products we manufacture; and
- members of the local community affected by our operations.

Employees have additional statutory rights, and the employee route in Section 8 reflects the Acas Code of Practice on disciplinary and grievance procedures. All other stakeholders use the external stakeholder route, also in Section 8.

This procedure does not replace other channels where they exist — for example routine product complaints, or matters covered by our disciplinary, anti-bribery or safeguarding policies. Where a concern is better handled under another policy, we will tell the person and signpost the correct route rather than simply closing the matter.

3. Definitions

- **Grievance** — any concern, problem or complaint that a stakeholder raises relating to our business, operations, conduct, or the behaviour of our people.
- **Complainant** — the person or organisation raising the grievance.

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- **Grievance Officer** — the named individual responsible for managing grievances under this procedure (Section 6).
 - **Case owner** — the named individual accountable for resolving a specific grievance and for meeting its target resolution date (Section 11).
 - **Retaliation** — any detriment, disadvantage or unfavourable treatment of a person because they have raised, or supported, a grievance in good faith.

4. Our principles

- **Accessibility** — anyone can raise a grievance, in writing or verbally, in plain language, free of charge, without needing to know our internal structure.
- **Safety** — a grievance can be raised anonymously, and no one is required to identify themselves in order to be heard (Section 7).
- **Fairness** — grievances are handled impartially. No one decides on a matter in which they are personally involved.
- **Timeliness** — we work to the published deadlines in Section 8 and tell people promptly if more time is genuinely needed, with a reason.
- **Confidentiality** — information is shared only with those who need it to resolve the matter (Section 10).
- **No retaliation** — anyone who raises a grievance in good faith is protected from retaliation (Section 9).
- **Accountability** — every accepted grievance has a named owner, a target date, and a recorded outcome (Section 11).

5. Grounds for accepting a grievance

We will accept and investigate a grievance where it concerns, for example:

- working conditions, treatment at work, pay, or health and safety;
- discrimination, bullying, harassment or victimisation;
- the conduct or decisions of our employees, managers or directors;
- the way we treat suppliers, contractors, brand partners or their workers;
- the impact of our operations on customers, the community or the environment;
- the accuracy or fairness of our marketing and public claims; or
- a breach of our policies, values or legal obligations.

A grievance may not be accepted where it is clearly outside the scope of this procedure, is more appropriately dealt with under another policy or legal process, or is found after review to be vexatious or made in bad faith. Where we do not accept a matter as a grievance, we will explain the reason to the complainant in writing, and record the decision and its reason in the register.

6. Roles and responsibilities

Grievance Officer

The designated individual responsible for managing grievances is **Boyowa Olugbo, Managing Director**. Their responsibilities are to:

- receive grievances and acknowledge them within the published deadline;
- decide whether a matter is accepted as a grievance, and on which route;
- assign a named case owner and a target resolution date to every accepted grievance;
- lead or arrange a fair and impartial investigation;
- keep the complainant informed at each step and communicate the outcome;

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- maintain the grievance register and ensure each case is recorded, owned and closed; and
 - report to the Board quarterly and prepare the annual grievance summary (Section 11).

Independent external channel — in progress

The Board has resolved that the impartiality of this procedure requires a reporting channel that does not come to the company first. An independent external provider is being appointed, with a target of **Q1 2027**. Once in place, any stakeholder will be able to raise a concern through that provider — including a concern about a Director — and the report will reach the Board without passing through management.

Until that channel is in place, the internal arrangement below applies and is disclosed as an interim measure rather than presented as an independent one.

Alternate

Where a grievance concerns the Grievance Officer, or where they have a conflict of interest, the matter is handled instead by **Robert Price, Director (robert@praxisbrands.co.uk)**. Where a grievance concerns a Director, it is handled by **Robert Price, Director**, or, where the grievance concerns both Directors, an independent third party appointed by the Board and reported to the Board in full.

Impartiality note. The Managing Director currently acts as Grievance Officer. To preserve impartiality, any grievance concerning the Managing Director, the conduct of management, or a decision he took is handled from receipt by the Alternate, and is reported to the Board in full. The Board keeps this arrangement under review and is appointing an independent external channel as set out above. The company does not describe the present internal arrangement as impartial oversight.

Others

Managers support informal resolution and cooperate fully with investigations. **The Board** hears appeals, receives quarterly grievance reporting, and ensures this procedure is properly resourced, reviewed and publicly available.

7. How to raise a grievance

A grievance can be raised:

- by email to **boyowa@praxisbrands.co.uk**;
- through the form published at **praxisbrands.co.uk/grievance**;
- by post to: The Grievance Officer, Praxis Brands Ltd, Unit 2 Crossways, Bicester Road, Aylesbury, HP18 0RA; or
- verbally to any manager or to the Grievance Officer, who will record it in writing and confirm the record with the complainant; or
- where the grievance concerns the Managing Director or a decision of management, direct to the Alternate, **Robert Price, Director, at robert@praxisbrands.co.uk**, who handles it from receipt and takes it to the Board in full.

Raising a grievance anonymously

A grievance may be submitted without giving a name. Anonymous grievances are recorded, assigned an owner and investigated so far as is possible on the information given. Where we cannot reach the complainant, the outcome is recorded in the register and, where appropriate, summarised in the annual grievance summary so that the response is still visible.

Support

The submission form at Appendix A may be used but is not compulsory. We will help anyone who needs support to put a grievance in writing, including in a language other than English, at no cost to them.

8. The procedure and deadlines

Acknowledgement. We acknowledge every grievance within **5 working days** of receipt and confirm who is handling it and the target resolution date.

Employee route

Stage	What happens	Deadline
1 — Informal	Where appropriate, the employee raises the matter with their manager, who tries to resolve it informally.	Within 10 working days
2 — Formal	If unresolved or too serious for the informal route, the employee submits a written grievance and is invited to a meeting.	Invitation within 5 working days
3 — Investigation	An impartial investigation is carried out by someone not involved in the matter.	Aim to complete in 15 working days
4 — Meeting	The grievance meeting is held. The employee has the statutory right to be accompanied by a colleague or trade union representative.	Within 10 working days of the written grievance
5 — Outcome	The outcome and any actions are confirmed in writing, with the right of appeal explained.	Within 5 working days of the meeting
6 — Appeal	The employee may appeal in writing. The appeal is heard by a Director not previously involved; the decision is final.	Appeal within 10 working days; heard within 10; outcome within 5

External stakeholder route

For grievances from suppliers, contractors, brand partners, customers, community members and others, the Grievance Officer acknowledges within **5 working days**, assigns a named case owner, investigates as needed, and provides a substantive written response within **20 working days** of acknowledgement. Where the matter is complex and more time is genuinely required, we tell the complainant before the deadline passes, give a reason, and set a revised date.

Review. A complainant dissatisfied with the outcome may request a review within **10 working days**. The review is carried out by a Director not previously involved and completed within **15 working days**. The review decision is final under this procedure and does not affect any legal right the complainant may have.

9. Protection from retaliation

No one who raises a grievance in good faith, or who supports or gives evidence in a grievance, will suffer any detriment for having done so. This applies to employees, contractors, suppliers and their workers alike — including, for suppliers, the continuation of their commercial relationship with us.

Retaliation is itself a disciplinary matter and, where it involves a supplier or partner, a contractual one. Any allegation of retaliation is treated as a new grievance of the highest priority and reported to the Board.

10. Confidentiality and data

Information about a grievance is shared only with those who need it to investigate or resolve the matter. Records are held securely, processed in accordance with UK GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018, and retained for **6 years** from closure before secure deletion.

Where anonymised, grievance data may be used in our register, our Board reporting and our published annual summary. We do not publish anything that could reasonably identify a complainant without their explicit consent.

11. Tracking grievances and assigning accountability

Recording a grievance is not the same as resolving one. This section sets out how every grievance is tracked to closure and who is answerable for it.

The grievance register

The Grievance Officer maintains a single register of all grievances — accepted and not accepted, named and anonymous — in the format at Appendix C. Every entry records, as a minimum:

- a unique reference and the date received;
- the stakeholder type and the subject of the grievance;
- **the named case owner** accountable for resolving it;
- the target resolution date, and any revision to it with the reason;
- current status, the outcome, and the actions agreed;
- the date the outcome was communicated and the date closed; and
- whether a review or appeal was requested, and its outcome.

Accountability

- **Every accepted grievance has one named case owner.** Ownership is assigned at acknowledgement, not after investigation, and is never left with “the company” or a team.
- **The case owner is accountable for the target date.** Where a date will be missed, the owner must notify the Grievance Officer and the complainant before it passes, with a reason and a revised date.
- **Agreed actions have owners and dates of their own.** A grievance is not closed because it has been answered; it is closed when the actions arising from it have been completed and verified.
- **Closure is confirmed by a second person.** The Grievance Officer, or the Alternate where the Officer was the case owner, confirms closure using the record at Appendix B.

Oversight and reporting

- **Quarterly.** The Grievance Officer reports to the Board on volume, type, open cases, overdue cases and any pattern emerging. Overdue cases are named and explained.
- **Annually.** We publish a grievance summary alongside our annual impact reporting: the number received by stakeholder type, the number resolved, average time to resolution, the number overdue, and what we changed as a result. It reports shortfalls as well as progress.
- **Systemic issues.** Where the register shows a recurring cause rather than a set of isolated incidents, the Grievance Officer raises it to the Board as a governance matter, not a casework one.

12. Availability of this procedure

This procedure is published openly at praxisbrands.co.uk/grievance, is accessible without a login or account, and is linked from our site footer and our supplier and client onboarding documentation. A copy is displayed at our operating premises and provided to every worker on induction. It is available in alternative formats on request.

13. Review

This procedure is reviewed at least annually, and sooner if there is a relevant change in law, in our operations, or in light of the annual grievance summary. Changes are approved by the Board and the revised version is republished with a new version number and date.

14. Approval

Approved by: Boyowa Olugbo, Managing Director, for and on behalf of Praxis Brands Ltd

Date: 15 August 2026

Signature: _____

Appendix A — Grievance submission form

Use of this form is optional. A grievance can also be raised by email, by post, verbally, or anonymously.

Reference (office use)	
Date received	
Your name (optional — you may submit anonymously)	
Stakeholder type	Employee / Contractor / Supplier / Client / Brand partner / Customer / Community / Other
Contact details (email / phone)	
Preferred contact method	
Details of the grievance — what happened, when, who was involved	
What outcome are you seeking?	
Have you tried to resolve this informally? (Y/N)	
Supporting information attached	
Signature / date	

Appendix B — Outcome and closure record

Completed by the case owner and confirmed by the Grievance Officer for each accepted grievance. Retained as evidence of resolution.

Grievance reference
Date received
Complainant / stakeholder type
Named case owner
Summary of grievance
Investigation steps taken
Meeting(s) held (dates)
Outcome / decision
Actions agreed — with owner and date

for each

Actions verified complete (date)

Review or appeal (Y/N) and outcome

Date communicated to complainant

Date closed

Closure confirmed by (second person)

Appendix C — Grievance register

A running log of all grievances, accepted and not accepted. Status is updated as each case progresses and the register is the source for quarterly Board reporting and the annual summary.

Ref	Date recd	Stakeholder type	Subject	Case owner	Status	Target date	Date closed	Outcome